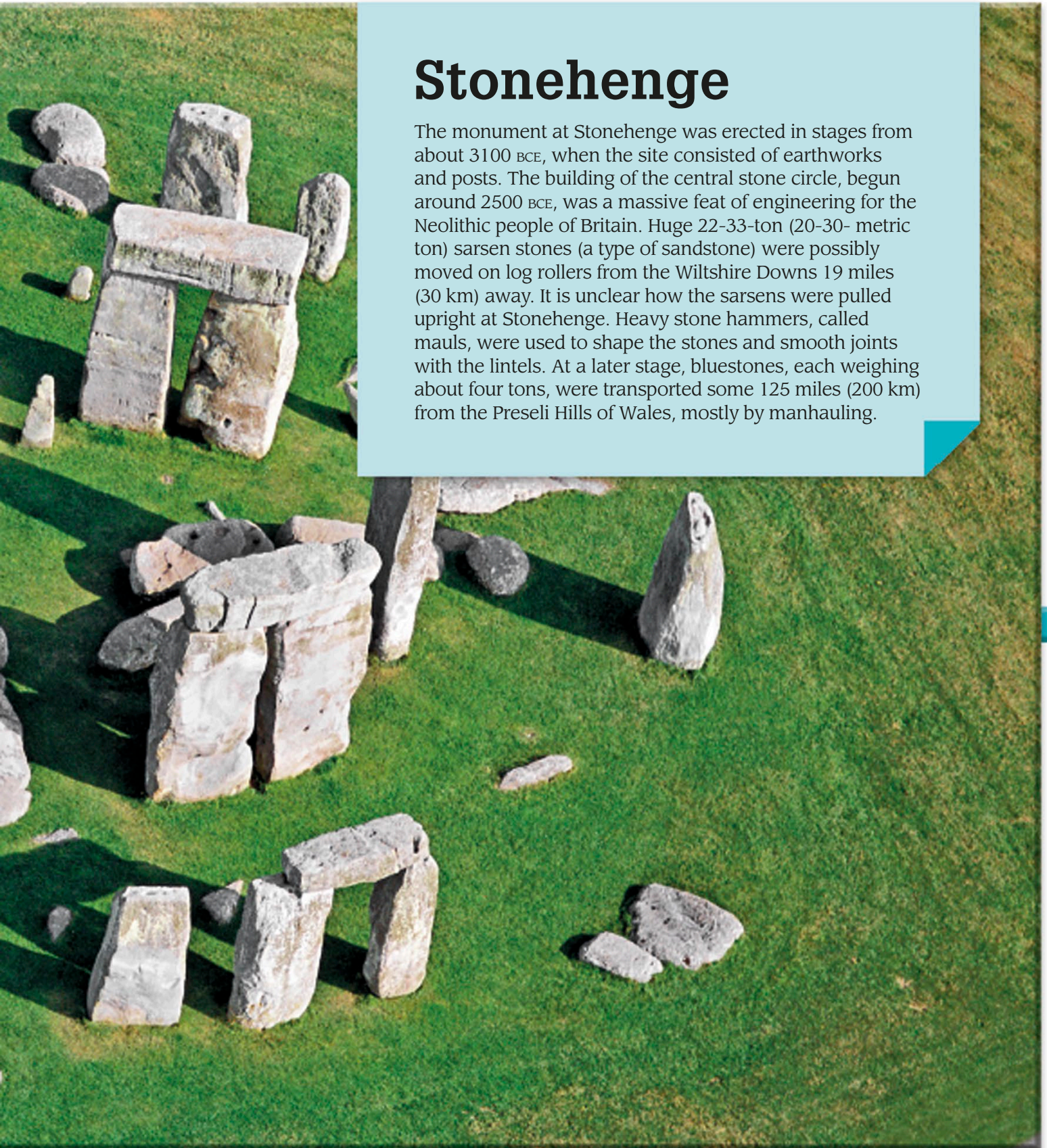


Stonehenge

The monument at Stonehenge was erected in stages from about 3100 BCE, when the site consisted of earthworks and posts. The building of the central stone circle, begun around 2500 BCE, was a massive feat of engineering for the Neolithic people of Britain. Huge 22-33-ton (20-30-metric ton) sarsen stones (a type of sandstone) were possibly moved on log rollers from the Wiltshire Downs 19 miles (30 km) away. It is unclear how the sarsens were pulled upright at Stonehenge. Heavy stone hammers, called mauls, were used to shape the stones and smooth joints with the lintels. At a later stage, bluestones, each weighing about four tons, were transported some 125 miles (200 km) from the Preseli Hills of Wales, mostly by manhauling.



This is an aerial view of the central stone circle at Stonehenge in Wiltshire, southern England. Originally, almost all the pairs of standing stones had a third horizontal stone called a lintel on top, but many of these have since fallen down.